

Partnership Proposal: GGP x Take-Two Interactive

Renewing and Expanding Our Partnership · 12 Months · July 2026 to July 2027

Prepared by Gay Gaming Professionals · Draft 4 · May 28, 2026

Cover

To: Alan Lewis, VP Corporate Communications & Public Affairs, Take-Two Interactive (cc as appropriate: Chanel Ward, Molly Sewalk, Ethan Friedman / 2K leadership; Isabella Begazo, T2 NY)

From: Gordon Bellamy, CEO, Gay Gaming Professionals

Subject: Renewing what we built, three options for July 2026 to July 2027

Read-ahead for: the next standing **EXCELLENCE** cadence meeting

Why now

Twenty years of GGP. Four years of partnership with Take-Two. The 2022 inclusion video series is still cited. The CYSTEM Mentorship Program you and I formalized in 2023 is still placing students into careers, including the **first GGP Scholar Alum named to Forbes 30 Under 30 (September 2025)**. The annual **2K Studio Tour at GDC** has become tradition. You personally participated again at GDC 2026, and your presence at the **GGP Scholars Breakfast** that Christopher Kim coordinated last year was felt across the whole cohort. The "EXCELLENCE" cadence keeps working.

Now the talent pipeline needs us at our best. The students we are mentoring this year are graduating into the hardest entry-level market in two decades. **AI readiness** has become the new threshold question for talent attraction in the games industry. Take-Two's own April 2026 recalibration of its AI strategy is a public signal of where the puck is going. And our shared work, supporting *all students pursuing careers in games, including those from underestimated communities*, has never been more relevant to Take-Two's culture and to the next generation.

This document proposes **three options** for renewing our partnership for the **next 12 months (July 2026 to July 2027)**. All three slot inside an existing partnership budget structure. All three are framed as continuations of work we already do well together. **None require approvals beyond the corporate communications and partnerships function.**

Three options at a glance

Option	Investment	Best for
Option A — Renewal	\$60,000	A focused refresh of our 2022 series, on a Pride 2026 to Pride 2027 timeline
Option B — Renewal + Pipeline + AI 🌟	\$200,000	The full continuation of our existing partnership, with the additions 2026 calls for
Option C — Multi-Year Flagship	\$400,000+ over 24 months	A 2-year flagship if Take-Two has the bandwidth and wants the visibility

We are presenting all three because the choice belongs at Take-Two. **Our recommendation is Option B.** It is the natural continuation of every program we already run together, plus the two additions our community has asked us to lead on this year: AI readiness and a more intentional public-facing student directory.

Option A — Renewal: refreshed video series

\$60,000 · 6-month engagement · launches Pride 2026 (June), full series rolls through Pride 2027

The 2022 inclusion video series is still the single most-cited public asset of our partnership. Option A funds a refreshed second edition.

What it delivers:

- 5 new short-form pieces (4 to 6 minutes each) co-produced with Take-Two ERG members across corporate, 2K, and Zynga
- Vertical/social cuts for TikTok, Reels, Shorts
- A "behind the series" mini-doc on how Take-Two's culture of belonging shows up in product
- Co-developed topic list with Take-Two corporate comms (proposed: AI literacy, accessibility in games, generational craft, employee belonging stories from Take-Two's own studios, world impact)

Where it shows up:

- GGP YouTube channel (primary; the *GGP Scholars Content* playlist already houses *The 2K Experience* / *GGP at GDC '24* as canonical co-branded asset)
- Take-Two corporate channels (mirror)
- Pride 2026 and Pride 2027 press cycles: GamesBeat, PocketGamer.biz, Polygon

What we own: content production, distribution, press

What Take-Two owns: ERG access, brand approvals, internal comms

Honest assessment: Option A is the safe choice. It refreshes one asset. It does not extend the **CYSTEM Mentorship**, the **2K Studio Tour**, the **Scholars Breakfast**, or address **AI readiness**. Several pieces of value are left on the table.

Option B — Renewal + Pipeline + AI

Our recommended choice

\$200,000 · 12-month engagement · spans Pride 2026 to GDC 2027 to Pride 2027

Option B includes everything in Option A, plus the structural pieces that already work and the two additions 2026 calls for.

B.1 — Refreshed Video Series (\$60K)

Same as Option A, scope-identical. Pride 2026 launch; full series through Pride 2027.

B.2 — Named CYSTEM Scholarship Cohort with Take-Two (\$90K)

A 12-month cohort of **15 scholars** from across the country, supporting all students pursuing careers in games, including those from underestimated communities. Pulls forward the structure Alan and Mason established in 2023; this is **CYSTEM Year 4** under Alex Rogers's continued leadership.

- \$5,000 scholarship × 15 students = \$75,000
- \$1,000 GDC 2027 travel stipend × 15 students = \$15,000
- 1-on-1 ERG mentor pairings (each scholar matched with a Take-Two ERG member)
- 6 mentor sessions over the year, GGP-curated

B.3 — Annual 2K Studio Tour + Scholars Breakfast, Take-Two as named industry sponsor of GDC 2027 (\$25K)

- Underwrites the **2K Studio Tour** for the cohort and the **GGP Scholars Breakfast** at GDC 2027 in San Francisco
- Both are existing traditions Alan personally values and participates in
- Take-Two named as the industry sponsor, visible at the event, in press, and in our annual report

B.4 — AI Readiness Track for the Rising Generation (\$25K)

Brand-new addition. Embedded in CYSTEM and CGC.

- "AI in the Studio" curriculum module added to CYSTEM Mentorship
- AI fluency office hours led by Take-Two engineers and GGP industry partners
- "AI in the Studio" panel at the 2K Studio Tour at GDC 2027
- Closing reflection: how AI is reshaping the entry-level role in games, and what scholars need to be ready for

Outcomes (12-month metrics):

- Video series: at least 1M cumulative views, 2K+ press impressions

- Cohort: 15 scholars deployed, 80% mentor-pairing completion, at least 3 cohort members hired into industry roles by July 2027
- 2K Tour + Breakfast: 45+ scholars in attendance at GDC 2027 (matches 2026 baseline)
- AI track: 100% of cohort completes the module; at least 5 case-study reflections published
- Relationship: renewable into Option C for 2027 to 2028 if all four land

What we own: scholarship deployment, mentor curation, AI curriculum, content production, GDC programming, public storytelling

What Take-Two owns: ERG access, AI engineer access, brand approvals, breakfast presence

Option C — Multi-Year Flagship

\$400,000+ over 24 months (July 2026 to July 2028)

Option C is presented if Take-Two wants to make GGP × Take-Two a named multi-year flagship.

What it would add on top of Option B:

- Year 2 mirroring of the cohort + Studio Tour + Breakfast
- A **public-good directory** of US video game education programs (companion document, see *US Video Game Education & Scholars Pipeline, Starter Directory, Draft 3*) hosted under co-branding, "Powered by Take-Two Interactive"
- A New York-based mirror of the **GGP × Games for Change charity poker tournament** (the inaugural one, hosted by Mike + Amy Morhaime, just funded two GGP/G4C Scholars for 2026 to 2027; there is appetite to mirror the model)
- A second "Belonging Round 3" video series in 2027

Honest assessment: Option C is a big swing. It commits Take-Two to a 24-month horizon. It would make GGP × Take-Two the most visible industry-pipeline partnership in games. We are presenting it because some of our peer organizations have suggested Take-Two might want this scale of visibility around major 2027 launches. We respect Take-Two's discipline on commitments and are not pushing Option C unless the bandwidth is there.

What changes vs. our existing partnership

Across all three options, **nothing about how we already work together changes**. The 2K Studio Tour stays. The mentorship structure stays. Our annual cadence with Alan stays. The Scholars Breakfast at GDC stays. We are renewing what works and adding what 2026 calls for.

Why Option B is right for July 2026 to July 2027

- **It slots inside Alan's existing partnership budget**, no escalation required
- **It renews three traditions Take-Two already participates in** (video series, CYSTEM mentorship, 2K Studio Tour + Breakfast)

- **It adds AI readiness**, the talent-pipeline question every games company is currently navigating, including Take-Two
- **It costs less than a single tier-2 GDC sponsorship line item** but produces compounding pipeline value across 12 months
- **At \$13,333 per direct beneficiary** (15 scholars), it is well below industry benchmarks for entry-level pipeline ROI
- **It positions Take-Two as the industry's most consistent partner** in supporting the rising generation, exactly when consistency is rare
- **The Sinjin / Bigglesworth Family Foundation parallel partnership** (the *T2 2025 Support* thread you and Sinjin opened, plus the Bigglesworth-sponsored IGNITE Impact Challenge in cycle now) means GGP is already sitting at the connective tissue between two of Take-Two's natural funder peers, a structural advantage for any multi-year flagship

Risk + mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Take-Two budget constraint in 2026	Option A is the fallback; Option B is structured so each component can be modular if needed
Mentor matching at scale	GGP pre-recruits 25+ Take-Two ERG members for the pool; mentor handbook + monthly office hours
AI track scope creep	Curriculum is delivered by GGP partners; Take-Two provides 2 to 3 engineer office hours, not full curriculum ownership
Series content gets caught in approval	Co-developed topic list at kickoff; staged approval gates rather than one big sign-off
GDC 2027 timing tight for Option B	Pride 2026 launch (Option A piece) decoupled from GDC 2027 deliverables
Conflicts with Take-Two's existing ERG load	All asks scoped to 6 hours or less per ERG member per year

What we need from Take-Two

- **A point person**, Alan, ideally, with a 2K and Zynga ERG liaison
- **ERG access**, 8 to 12 ERG members on camera (Option A piece) and 25+ in the mentor pool (Option B piece)
- **AI engineer access**, 2 to 3 Take-Two engineers for office hours and the GDC 2027 panel
- **Brand approvals**, co-branding rights with staged review

- **Communications coordination**, a joint Pride 2026 press cycle and joint GDC 2027 moment
- **An MOU and a contract.** Option B paid in three tranches: 50% at kickoff (July 2026), 25% at Pride 2027 launch, 25% at GDC 2027

Why GGP, and why now

- **Track record:** 20 years of cultivating top performers in the games industry. First GGP Scholar Alum on Forbes 30 Under 30 (Sept 2025). Audrey Webb at Roblox. Ami Cai at NYS Empire State Development. Christopher Kim at USC Marshall.
- **Organizational stability: Eric Francksen formally takes the title Executive Producer, GGP, in 2026.** He has been the operational backbone for six years. Take-Two's GGP work runs through him in practice: the 2K Studio Tour, the Scholars Breakfast coordination, the CYSTEM year-over-year cadence.
- **Ecosystem position:** GDC 2026 partnership with Informa. **IGNITE Impact Challenge** with Eric Francksen, Bec Godsey, and Games for Change, sponsored by **Bigglesworth Family Foundation** (Sinjin Bain), in cycle now with submissions closing May 29. GGP is a *budgeted participant* in the IIC partnership, not a pass-through sponsor; the partner-tier seat is structured at the Bigglesworth + G4C level. Global Game Jam host (third year). Co-funded scholars with Games for Change via the Mike + Amy Morhaime charity poker tournament. We sit at the connective tissue.
- **Collegiate Games Challenge, inaugural year wrapped cleanly in August 2025:** \$90,000 awarded across 21 invited universities, three categories (Interactive, Business, Cinematic), with Raw Thrills (Eugene Jarvis) as the inaugural underwriting partner. USC, Michigan State, SCAD, and Indiana University were all in the recognized cohort. The 2026 cycle is in development; partner-of-record not yet announced.
- **Content credibility:** the 2022 series with you remains the gold standard. The *GGP Scholars Content* YouTube playlist, including *The 2K Experience | GGP at GDC '24*, is the standing public anchor of our co-produced storytelling.
- **Faculty presence:** USC Games faculty (Gordon), with **USC Games' Tracy Fullerton on the Games for Change board** and Tencent's Ben Golant also on G4C. The board overlap is real.
- **Talent pipeline depth:** GGP Scholars + CYSTEM + Collegiate Games Challenge + Global Game Jam + GGP × G4C funded scholars = **five programs each touching different points of the pipeline.**

Companion documents (delivered alongside this proposal)

- **US Video Game Education & Scholars Pipeline, Starter Directory, Draft 3** (*see attached Drive link*)
- **Pipeline One-Sheet, Where GGP sits in the games-education ecosystem** (*see attached Drive link*)
- **Relationship Research Brief, Draft 2** (*prior; available on request*)

Next step

A 30-minute call with Alan, and whoever from 2K he wants on the line, at the next standing **EXCELLENCE** cadence to:

- Confirm Option B (or remix)
- Co-develop the video series topic list
- Lock the budget tranche structure
- Commit to a Pride 2026 launch window
- Calendar the GDC 2027 moment

Gordon is ready when Take-Two is.

Built to be shared with the Take-Two Foundation board. Easy to read, easy to forward, easy to say yes to.